



Mainstream Laptops

Last year, the knives were out, and obituaries spewed everywhere. Tablets were out-selling laptops, as the post-PC era had well and truly begun. Notebook PCs aren't going down without a fight, oh no sir! This year proves it beyond any shadow of doubt, that laptops are the new desktop PCs – they're not as popular as they once were, but that doesn't mean no one wants one, either. The laptop computers launched this year have evolved to be slightly sleeker, more trendy than ever before. And when it comes to internal hardware, they've continued to keep pace with the latest and greatest component level refreshes to give users a greater buying proposition – specially in the performance segment.

Equipped with the latest Intel Core processors, and the fastest, newer and improved graphics chips from AMD and NVIDIA, nothing could stop some of the fastest laptops we've reviewed this year from giving full-fledged desktop computers a good run for their money.

Zero1 Winner

Lenovo IdeaPad Y50-70

This 15-inch laptop from Lenovo is a premium product, aimed towards users who desire the best entertainment – be it multimedia or gaming – and it does so with great aplomb. The IdeaPad Y50-70 notebook comes with a very good, if not impressive, combination of hardware components: just take a look – a quad-core Intel Core i7-4710HQ processor clocked at 2.5 GHz (with Turbo Boost capability of reaching 3.5 GHz), 8GB RAM, 1TB HDD + 8GB SSD (hybrid storage), and NVIDIA GeForce GTX 860M graphics with 4GB GDDR5 dedicated memory. Forget day-to-day multitasking – it handles all that with a yawn – this ensures that most modern games are playable easily at high settings. No complaints from the device's HD 1080p screen or audio performance (thanks to onboard JBL speakers) either, as it continued to hold its head up high throughout our performance tests. The laptop's backlit keyboard and touchpad are definitely one of the best input device combos we've had the pleasure of interacting with this year. The keyboard's typing experience is near perfect and the touchpad's feedback is equally impressive. One thing's obvious about this laptop – you won't be disappointed by its performance.



◀ **LENOVO IDEAPAD Y50-70**

Price: ₹79,990

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Toshiba Satellite P50t-B

This laptop comes with the exact same CPU as the Lenovo Y50-70, 16GB of RAM, 1TB hard drive, and AMD Radeon R9 M265X graphics with 2GB GDDR5 memory. This Toshiba laptop's pièce de résistance is obviously its 4K UHD display, which Toshiba proudly claims to be the "first in the world" for a laptop screen. The IPS display is very good and the 4K resolution is definitely great to work with. However, despite having a pretty good GPU, gaming on 4K is far from perfect, and the graphics performance is just a notch below our Zero1 Winner. With a brushed metal screen lid and an all-silver look, the Toshiba Satellite P50 carries its premium laptop tag with great distinction. Its brushed metal screen lid feels great, backlit keyboard is a joy to use, and a responsive, well-built touchpad, rounds up a very good input experience. Even its onboard audio, courtesy of Harman Kardon speakers, is better than most others. The audio visual experience on this machine is worth experiencing. This isn't a mass market laptop by any stretch of the imagination, limited only to early adopters and geeks who want to boast of a 4K display notebook. Worth every penny, if you desire this.



Toshiba Satellite P50t-B

Price: ₹86,000



Acer Aspire E5-571G

Price: ₹63,000

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Acer Aspire E5-571G

The Aspire E5-571G seems like an unimpressive laptop from the outside, but its innards are what matters here: there's an Intel Core i7-4510U processor in there, accompanied by 12GB of RAM, 1TB hard drive, and NVIDIA GeForce 820M graphics with 2GB of dedicated VRAM. Overall, in terms of performance, this laptop comes behind the Lenovo and Toshiba notebooks, and is a nice option to consider for anyone who's interested in a multimedia device which can also dabble in gaming and not stutter or suck at it. 